

Your company has data. But does it have a strategy?

Why so many organisations are data-rich but insight-poor, and what separates those that compete on data from those that simply store it.

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A preview of the Nottingham Digital Strategy Immersion Week in partnership with PECEGE



Everyone is investing. Few are competing.

9 in 10

executives rank data & AI investment as a top organisational priority

Bean, R., & Davenport, T. H. (2026). Survey: How Executives Are Thinking About AI in 2026. Harvard Business Review.

~1 in 2

would describe their organisation as genuinely data-driven

Bean, R., & Davenport, T. H. (2026). Survey: How Executives Are Thinking About AI in 2026. Harvard Business Review.

~70%

of digital transformations fall short of their objectives

Forth, et al (2020). Flipping the Odds of Digital Transformation Success. BCG

The bottleneck is no longer collecting data. It is converting data into decisions, and decisions into strategy.

Data is not insight. Insight is not strategy.

Most organisations stall here, reporting the past instead of shaping the future



Each step needs a different capability: the first two are technical, the last three are organisational.

Why the gap exists



Culture eats analytics for breakfast

Executives consistently cite people, process and culture (not technology) as the main barrier to becoming data-driven.



Decisions have no owners

Data flows into reports, but no one is accountable for changing a specific decision because of it.



Data is trapped in silos

Each function optimises its own numbers; nobody sees the enterprise picture that strategy requires.



Pilots without a thread

Dozens of disconnected proofs-of-concept, none tied to how the organisation intends to win.



Translators are scarce

The bridge roles, people fluent in both the business and the data, are the rarest talent in the market.

Six symptoms of a data-rich, insight-poor organisation



Dashboard theatre

Hundreds of reports produced; nobody can name a decision one of them changed last quarter.



Slow answers

A simple business question takes weeks and three departments to answer.



Duelling numbers

Two teams present two versions of the same KPI. The meeting becomes a debate about whose data is right.



Collect first, ask later

Data is hoarded “because it might be useful”.



HiPPO decisions

When data and opinion conflict, the highest-paid person's opinion still wins.



Insight without action

Analyses are praised, filed, and never change budget, pricing or priorities.

Storing data vs competing on data

Organisations that store data

Data is IT's responsibility

Success = systems live, reports shipped

Analytics answers 'what happened?'

Data projects follow the tech roadmap

Insight stays in the analytics team

Organisations that compete on data

Data is a leadership agenda, owned in the business

Success = decisions improved, outcomes moved

Analytics answers 'what should we do next?'

Data investments follow the strategy

Insight is embedded in everyday workflows

Cloud, big data and AI: one decision infrastructure



Cloud

The foundation

Elastic, shared, always-on. Frees data from departmental hardware and makes scale a utility.



Big data

The fuel

Volume, variety, velocity. Internal and external signals joined into a single picture of the business.



AI & analytics

The engine

From describing the past to predicting and recommending.

Together they form **decision infrastructure**: the platform that lets every function make faster, evidence-based choices. Technology is necessary. It is just not sufficient.

Stop asking “what can our data do?” Start asking “what decisions must we win?”

Data-driven (the default)

“We have all this data, what could we do with it?”

Leads to scattered pilots, tool-led projects and analytics that search for a problem.

Decision-driven

1. Name the 5–10 decisions that determine whether your strategy succeeds
2. Specify the insight each decision needs, at what speed and precision
3. Build only the data, models and skills that serve those decisions

Pricing, inventory, credit, maintenance, next-best-offer, network design: strategy lives in a small number of repeated decisions. Instrument those first.

Why most digital transformations still fall short

~70%

of transformation programmes fail to reach their stated goals

Forth, et al (2020). Flipping the Odds of Digital Transformation Success. BCG

1

Technology-first thinking

Platforms bought before the decisions they serve are defined.

2

Strategy and data run on separate tracks

The digital roadmap and the corporate strategy are written by different people, in different rooms.

3

Culture and skills underfunded

90% of budget on systems, 10% on the people meant to change how they work with them.

4

No way to measure decision impact

Progress tracked in milestones and go-lives, not in better outcomes.

What organisations that compete on data do differently



Treat data as a managed asset

Named owners, quality standards and a curated catalogue.



Put insight inside the workflow

Recommendations appear where the decision is made and not in a separate report.



Build the culture from the top

Leaders look at the evidence before stating their opinion, and reward teams that revise a plan when the data contradicts it.



Measure decisions, not dashboards

Track forecast accuracy, decision speed and outcome lift.

Three ways data becomes advantage



Better decisions

MARGIN

Pricing, promotions, credit, etc. The same choices, made with evidence, at higher precision and speed.



Precision analytics

COST & RESILIENCE

Forecasting, predictive maintenance, supply-chain visibility, etc. Disruptions anticipated instead of survived.



New offers & models

REVENUE

Data-enriched products, services and platforms. Insight your customers will pay for.

Five questions to ask your organisation

1

Which five decisions matter most to our strategy, and does data genuinely shape any of them today?

2

Can anyone name a decision a dashboard changed last quarter?

3

Who owns each critical decision, and do they trust the number in front of them?

4

If our analytics team vanished tomorrow, which business outcome would degrade first?

5

Are we funding data work by strategic importance or by whoever shouts loudest?

Seeing the gap takes 40 minutes.
Closing it takes capability.

A preview of the Digital Strategy Immersion Week
Nottingham University Business School × PECEGE

Digital Strategy Immersion Week



Expert-led sessions

AI, big data, cloud, machine learning, digital trends and strategy execution taught by academics and practitioners.



SAP-powered simulations

Hands-on business simulations in SAP Analytics Cloud: real decisions, real data, in the room.



Company visits

Digital strategy observed in the wild. Nottingham's innovation ecosystem plus leading firms in London.



Daily contextual insights

PECEGE-led mentorship each day, translating UK learning into strategy for your own market.

Why Nottingham

- Triple-accredited business school (AACSB · EQUIS · AMBA)
- Top 100 in the world (QS Rankings 2026)
- #1 SAP Russell Group university for hands-on SAP experience
- 1st in the UK for graduates entering highly skilled employment

The week at a glance

Day 1

NOTTINGHAM

Foundations

- AI, big data & cloud as decision infrastructure
- Machine learning for business
- Campus tour & welcome dinner

Day 2

NOTTINGHAM

Trends & innovation

- Five emerging digital techniques
- Innovation pipelines in practice
- Mixed Reality Lab visit

Day 3

NOTTINGHAM

Simulation I

- SAP Analytics Cloud hands-on
- City as Lab: place-based data
- Company visit: Datagum

Day 4

NOTTINGHAM

Simulation II + strategy

- Supply-chain decision simulation
- B2B digital strategy case study
- Monetising data · farewell dinner

Day 5

LONDON

Strategy in action

- Capgemini: delivering transformation
- Lego: e-commerce at global scale
- Closing contextual insights

Every day closes with a PECEGE Contextual Insights session turning the day's learning into strategy for your own organisation.

Company visits based on the 2025 edition; subject to availability for 2026. Sessions may change.

Dates and what is included



23–27 November 2026

Five days: Nottingham (Days 1–4) and London (Day 5)



Executive education certificate

Awarded by Nottingham University Business School

The fee includes

- ✓ All programme sessions and activities
- ✓ 5 nights on-campus accommodation in Nottingham
- ✓ Company visits, plus transport to London
- ✓ Breakfast and lunch daily; welcome and farewell dinners
- ✓ Graduation ceremony and certificate

Not included: flights, airport transfers, insurance and visas.

Data is abundant.
Strategy is scarce.
That is the opportunity.

Questions and discussion

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